BRAND GUIDELINES — VERSION 2.1

plugabyte

One letter carries the whole identity. The **a** is a single-storey letterform — a round bowl on the baseline, drawn as a ghost with two eyes and a soft hem. The bowl carries two large eyes and a soft two-footed hem, and a thunderbolt hangs from the notch, filling the descender space where a **g** tail would fall. Nothing crosses the face, so the big oval eyes carry all the expression. Read the lockup and it says **plug·a·byte**.

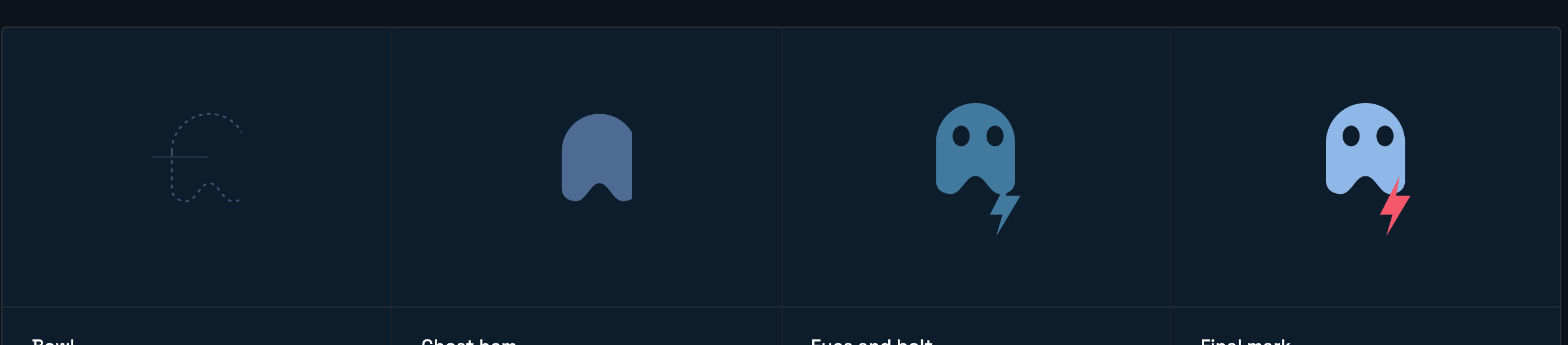
Sky & Bolt
Two colours on the mark

24 px
Smallest legible mark

16 states
Sprite state set

01 Constructing the A

A geometric single-storey **a** is a bowl on the baseline. Round the bowl fully, soften its base into a two-footed hem, then hang a thunderbolt from the notch into the descender. Nothing crosses the face.



Bowl
A round bowl sitting on the baseline at x-height.

Ghost hem
Three waves replace the flat base — the only trace of the ghost.

Eyes and bolt
Two large eyes set high in the bowl, and the bolt hanging from the hem notch. The eyes and the bolt are what the loops play with.

Final mark
Sky ghost, empty eyes, red bolt.

INCORRECT

plug byte

A full-height mark set between two words behaves as punctuation. The eye skips it and the name reads **plugbyte**.

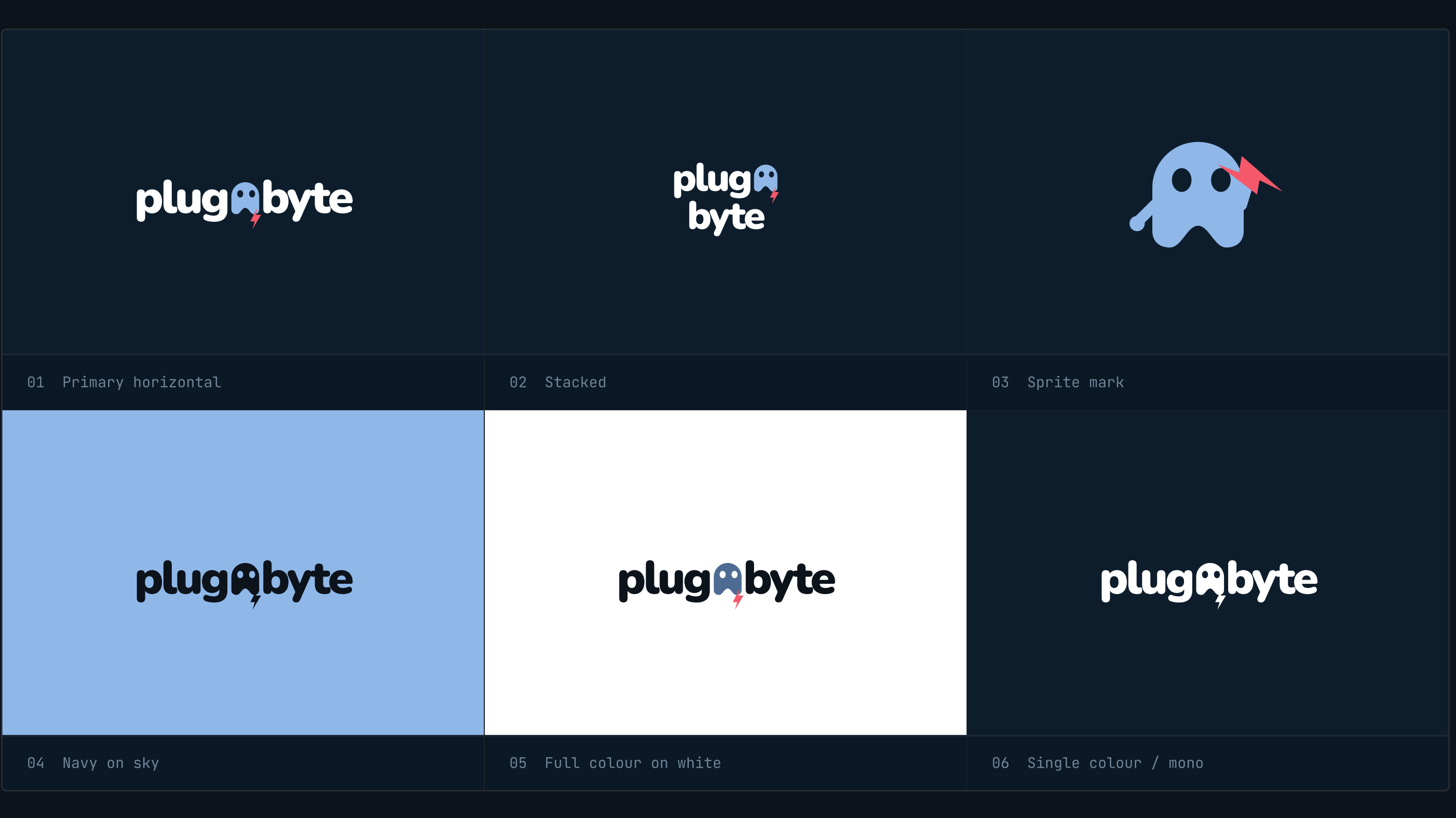
CORRECT

plugabyte

The bowl matches the x-height of the type around it and sits on the baseline beside the **b**, with the held bolt tucked into the descender so it never collides with the next letter.

02 Logo suite

Six approved lockups. Nothing outside this set is a plugabyte logo.

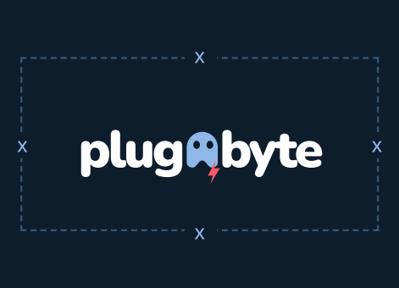


01 Primary horizontal
02 Stacked
03 Sprite mark
04 Navy on sky
05 Full colour on white
06 Single colour / mono

Clear space

Exclusion zone equals the bowl width **x** on all four sides. The bolt is part of the mark. In the typographic form it never leaves the descender; in the sprite it never leaves the hand, except on Toss, Launch, Shock and Around the world.

Lockup, digital	26 px
Lockup, print	14 mm
Glyph only	24 × 24 px
Wordmark tracking	-5%



Scale test

Twenty-four pixels is the floor. Below it the eyes close up, so smaller placements use the solid-eye variant from the asset pack.

03 The sign spinner

The bolt is a signboard and the ghost is the guy twirling it on the roadside. The sign is a child of the arm, not a sibling: the shoulder rotates, the sign rotates about the grip point sitting exactly at the hand, and position is expressed as arm rotation while spin is expressed as sign rotation — so the grip can never visibly separate. All sixteen states, ported directly from the reference rig.

plugabyte

`pb-mark`
Typographic form — the default
No arms, bolt hanging in the descender. Compact enough to sit between two letters — this is what the logo is in every static and inline placement.

`pb-sprite`
Working form — arms out, sign in hand
The same ghost and the same grip, arms extended so the sign can travel. Every state below is this sprite — the letter is simply this character standing still.

`pb-twirl`
Twirl
Sign spins on the grip while the shoulder breathes. The small-size rendering of Windmill — below 64 px, drop the arm sweep and keep just this.
`Button spinners, table cells, inline status.`

`pb-windmill`
Windmill
The one loading state. Shoulder sweeps a wide arc while the sign spins throughout. All the travel is arm rotation, so the grip never loosens.
`Every pending task — requests, builds, deploys, syncs.`

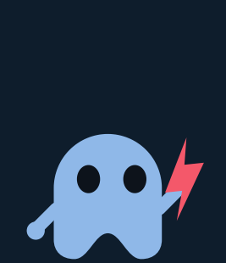
`pb-billboard`
Billboard
The bolt flattens into a board held level above the shoulder — arm and sign counter-rotate so net tilt is always zero — and fills left to right.
`Determinate progress: uploads, imports, checkout.`

`pb-wave`
Wave
The roadside wiggle. Shoulder and wrist swing on the same clock in opposite directions, which is what makes it snap.
`Notice this: new feature badge, unread count, export ready.`

`pb-shoulder`
Shoulder
Off duty. Sign resting across the shoulder, arm and sign breathing in phase, an occasional blink. Everything returns here.
`Idle default: sidebar, header, docs, marketing.`

`pb-slouch`
Slouch
Arm hangs, sign leaning at its side, eyes shut to slits. Nobody is driving past.
`Empty and off states: no results, integration disconnected.`

`pb-tap`
Tap
Arm brings the sign in against the body three times, then rests. Small and patient, not a spin.
`Typing indicator: streaming replies, live chat.`



`pb-around-the-world`
Around the world
A full wrap — released, swung wide, caught on the other side. Torso and eyes track it the whole way.
`Multi-step work: agent handoffs, queued jobs.`

`pb-static`
Static
Not a trick — ghost and sign as marching dashed outlines, held in the resting grip. Content-shaped, not attention-shaped.
`Skeleton placeholder inside cards and list rows.`

`pb-hoist`
Hoist
Ghost flickers in, then the shoulder swings up from the floor and the sign rights itself with an overshoot.
`First paint: app boot, route change, splash.`

`pb-toss`
Toss
Squat, release, two rotations airborne, spot it, catch. Departs and returns to the exact grip.
`Refresh and re-run: pull-to-refresh, retry.`

`pb-launch`
Launch
Sign is thrust past the camera and out of frame, ghost recoils, a fresh one swings up and settles.
`Send: message sent, form submitted, invite fired.`

`pb-flip-to-check`
Flip to check
A fast edge-on flip on the grip — the hand never lets go — and the sign lands showing a checkmark.
`Success: saved, paid, connected, deployed.`

`pb-shock`
Shock
The sign discharges into its holder. Arms lock rigid, arcs strobe off the body. Then the current cuts and it sags back.
`Errors: failed request, invalid input. One cycle only.`

`pb-fold`
Fold
Arm tucks down, sign folds away to nothing, then the ghost crushes into a spark that expands out of existence.
`Dismiss and delete: removed item, closed modal.`

`pb-pointer`
Pointer
Leans in from off-canvas, the bolt becomes a directional arrow, and the shoulder jabs it twice toward what you should look at.
`Onboarding and nudges: feature tours, empty-state CTAs.`

Position on the arm, spin on the sign
Translate the sign to move it and the grip breaks. Rotate the shoulder instead and the hand carries it for free.

One duration for arm and sign
Two different durations on a nested pair reads as "the bolt is doing its own thing."

Spin only when work is real
A twirling sign with nothing loading teaches users to ignore it.

04 Colour

Sky blue carries the brand; the bolt is the one red on the mark, and the same red is held back for a single primary action per screen. Flat colour only — no gradients on the mark.

Sky	Sky Light	Deep Sky	Night	Bolt Red	Chalk
#8FB8E8	#B9D8F2	#4E6C93	#0D131B	#F4586A	#F3F7FA
Primary	Highlight	Depth	Ground	The bolt · one CTA	Light ground

70 / 25 / 5
Seventy per cent ground, twenty-five sky, five red. Red is never a background colour.

Contrast
Body copy holds 4.5:1 minimum. Sky on Night passes; Sky on Chalk does not — use Deep Sky.

Two-tone mark
Sky ghost, red bolt. Mono versions exist only where a second colour is impossible.

05 Typography

Nunito for display and the wordmark — its geometric single-storey **a** is the source of the mark. Space Grotesk for everything else.

Nunito Google Fonts
Display, wordmark · 700–900
Aa
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz 0123456789

Space Grotesk Google Fonts
UI, body, captions · 300–700
Aa
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz 0123456789

TYPE SCALE

Display 56	**Plug in.**
H1 36	**The demo was the easy part**
H2 24	Section heading
Body 16	plugabyte builds the part that stays up — auth, state, error handling, monitoring, cost at real volume. The first 80% is nearly free now; the last 20% is where builds die.
Mono 13	`plugabyte.estimate(scope) → weeks`

06 Voice and taglines

POSITIONING

plugabyte builds the part that stays up.

The category is production engineering. Anyone can get to a working demo now — the remaining work is auth, permissions, state, error handling, data integrity, observability and cost at volume. That gap is the same whether the build is a new product, an internal tool, an AI agent, a pipeline or two systems that should be one workflow.

LEAD WITH
The failure mode the reader has already lived. A demo that fell over on real data. Name it in specifics — expired tokens, dropped webhooks, duplicate records, nobody watching.

NEVER
"AI-powered", "leverage", "end-to-end", "transformation". AI is how the work gets done, not what is sold. Never name a competing tool — the reader used it.

SCOPE OF WORK
Product builds · internal tools · AI agents · data pipelines · automations and integrations · prototype rescue. Integration is one branch, not the category.

EFFORT, NOT PRICE
Public surfaces quote effort in weeks, never money, and never without the assumptions in the same view. Pricing happens in conversation.

The v2.0 line — "connects the tools a team already runs, so work moves between them without anyone rebuilding the plumbing" — is retained as a descriptor for integration work only. It is no longer the top-line.

PRIMARY TAGLINE

Plug in. Light up. Ship it.

Three beats. Set in Nunito 900, sentence case, never all caps.

SECONDARY
The last 20% is the job.

SECONDARY
Built to stay up.

SECONDARY
Ships, and keeps shipping.

DIRECT
Short sentences, active verbs, no throat-clearing. Lead with the outcome.

WARM
Plain words over jargon. We write the way a good colleague explains something.

PRECISE
Name the number, the limit, the version. Specifics beat adjectives.

HONEST
Say what the product doesn't do. No hype, no revolutions.

NAMING THE GAP · AI BUILDS

Five things founders scoping an AI build systematically leave out. Naming them, with effort against each, is the strongest credibility move available — no adjective does comparable work.

Evals
The actual difference between a demo and a product, and almost nobody has them in their plan.

Prompt and version management
Including what happens to behaviour when a prompt changes.

Human handoff
The escalation path for when the model can't or shouldn't answer.

Cost per interaction
Modelled at real volume, not at demo volume.

Grounding and containment
What it does when it is wrong in front of a paying customer.

07 Usage

DO

Let the sprite be the a
Never set the lockup with both a typed **a** and the mark.

Spell it out in copy
Running text always uses the full word **plugabyte**, lowercase, one word.

Keep the bolt red
Two-tone is the signature: sky body, red bolt. Mono is only for single-colour reproduction.

Animate sparingly
One animated mark per screen, at rest by default. The letter never animates beyond a breathe and a blink — spinning belongs to the sprite.

DON'T

Don't raise the mark to cap height
It stops being a letter and the name reads plugbyte.

Don't write PlugAByte or Plug-a-Byte
One word, all lowercase, no camel case, no hyphens.

Don't add elements
No rings, sparks, outlines, glows or gradients. Motion comes from the mark's own parts.

Don't restyle the face
The oval eyes and the bolt are fixed geometry. They may move or blink; the eyes never change shape, and no mouth, brows or glasses are added.